Engineering College Monthly Operational Brief

Introduction

This monthly brief provides internal stakeholders with a consolidated view of College of Engineering operational priorities, risk items, and near-term deliverables. It is intended to support leadership decision-making, resource alignment, and timely escalation of issues that could impact academic quality and external expectations. The document summarizes status across key workstreams and highlights items requiring dean’s office attention. Audience includes department chairs, program directors, assessment leads, and college operations managers.

Continuous Improvement Workstream Updates

During the March 2026 operations review, the College of Engineering closed 11 of 14 Lean process tickets focused on lab purchasing cycle time and chemical inventory reconciliation. The Facilities & Safety team completed a 2-hour tabletop drill on 03/18/2026 and reduced average incident report processing from 9.4 days to 6.1 days. IT Services rolled out a new ServiceNow intake form for research computing requests, with 73 submissions logged in the first two weeks and a 22% drop in incomplete tickets. Separately, the college piloted a standardized meeting agenda template across five departments to improve decision traceability in monthly leadership huddles.

Faculty Staffing and Teaching Coverage

For Summer 2026 scheduling, the Dean’s Office finalized coverage for 126 course sections, including 18 online sections and 9 evening labs, with room assignments confirmed by 04/05/2026. Mechanical Engineering approved 6 graduate teaching assistant appointments, while Electrical & Computer Engineering added 4 adjuncts to support a projected 12% enrollment uptick in introductory courses. Across the college, 7 faculty members submitted sabbatical requests for AY26–27 and 3 lines were reallocated to align with strategic hiring in AI systems and advanced manufacturing. HR also completed I-9 reverification for 98% of part-time instructors ahead of the payroll cutoff on 03/29/2026.

Student Success Metrics and Advising

The Advising Center reported 2,184 student appointments in March 2026, with 61% conducted via virtual drop-in and average wait times improving from 19 minutes to 12 minutes. First-year engineering retention for the Fall 2025 cohort is tracking at 88.3% as of 03/31/2026, supported by a targeted outreach campaign that contacted 412 students flagged by early-term alerts. Career Services hosted three employer info sessions (03/12, 03/19, 03/26) with 27 companies and 684 total student attendees, resulting in 146 internship interview invitations. In parallel, the college expanded peer tutoring hours by 15% in Calculus I and Physics I after midterm grade distributions showed a 0.18 GPA dip compared to last spring.

Conclusion

This month’s work centers on closing documentation gaps, validating assessment evidence, and ensuring readiness across programs for upcoming external review milestones. The most immediate needs are timely department inputs, consistent artifact storage, and confirmation of ownership for remaining deliverables. Chairs and program directors should review the action register, confirm due dates, and flag any resourcing constraints within one week. The dean’s office will provide a mid-month checkpoint and adjust support based on risks identified.